

A FIELD GUIDE FOR PEOPLE WHO DESIGN SCREENS

THE UI/UX BIBLE.



why one screen feels right and the other one doesn't.

HIERARCHY

SPACING

TYPE

DENSITY

SYSTEMS



run the eye test. every screen. forever.

NOT GOOD APP VS BAD APP.

That gets subjective fast. Instead:

- 1. Take the same screen.
- 2. Duplicate it.
- 3. Break one or two principles on purpose.
- 4. Put them side by side. Now you can actually see what changed.

THE ONE RULE

"Don't tell me A looks cleaner. Tell me **WHY.**"

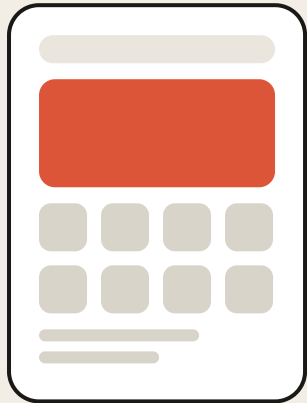


THE 10 COMPARISONS

01	Hierarchy	Swiggy / Zepto home	Where does your eye go first?
02	Spacing	Airbnb listing card	Which one feels calmer?
03	Typography	Spotify playlist	Why does one feel more organised?
04	Alignment	Notion settings	Something feels wrong. What is it?
05	Density	Zerodha Kite	Is more whitespace always better?
06	Colour	PhonePe / Razorpay	Which makes the next action clearer?
07	Components	Any SaaS dashboard	Why does the system look cheap?
08	Forms	Checkout / signup	Which fields feel related?
09	States	Order tracking	What is happening right now?
10	AI-generated UI	Figma Make dashboard	What did AI get right but visually wrong?

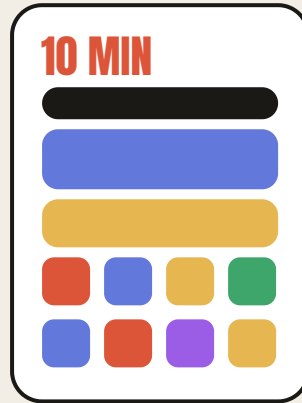
01 HIERARCHY

SCREEN / SWIGGY / ZEPTO HOME



A / ORIGINAL

A One thing wins. Search, banner, categories and offers each know their rank.



B / BROKEN

B Huge delivery time, bright discounts, colourful icons, strong search, competing banners. Each piece looks designed. Together, nothing wins.

"where does your eye go first?"

HIERARCHY IS DECIDING WHAT IS ALLOWED TO BE LOUD.

02 SPACING

SCREEN / AIRBNB LISTING CARD



A / ORIGINAL

A Image, 16px, name, 4px, location, 8px, price. Related things sit close.



B / BROKEN

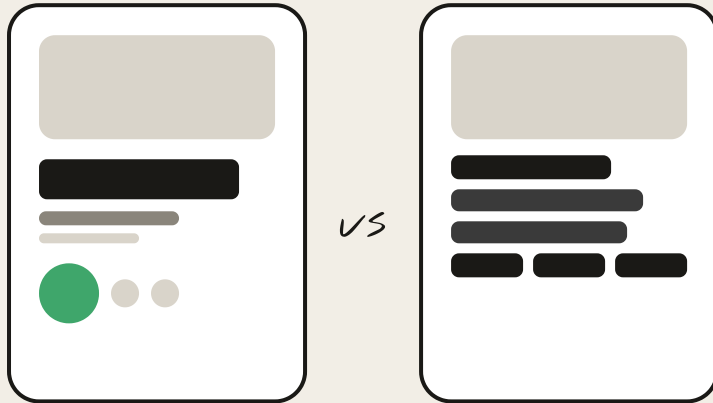
B Image, 24px, name, 18px, location, 18px, price. Or random 8 / 13 / 21 / 29px gaps. Nothing is broken, it just feels worse.

"which one feels calmer? why?"

DISTANCE COMMUNICATES RELATIONSHIP.

03 TYPOGRAPHY

SCREEN / SPOTIFY PLAYLIST PAGE



A / ORIGINAL

B / BROKEN

A Title 32px. Supporting copy 14px. Low-contrast metadata. One obvious primary action.

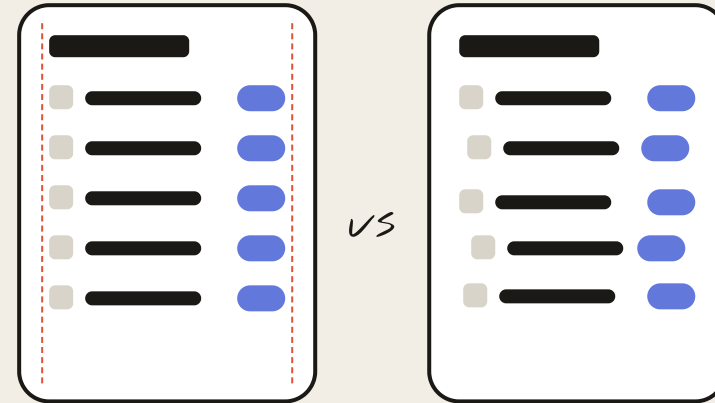
B Title 20px, artist 18px, metadata 17px, buttons 18px. Similar weights everywhere, 6 to 7 random sizes.

"why does one feel more organised?"

SIZE AND WEIGHT ARE HOW TEXT GETS RANKED.

04 ALIGNMENT

SCREEN / NOTION SETTINGS PAGE



A / ORIGINAL

B / BROKEN

A Label edges, icons and toggles share the same lines. Guides prove it.

B Things moved only 3 to 6px. Label edges drift, toggles sit in different spots, icons have different optical centres. Do not exaggerate it.

"something feels wrong. what is it?"

YOUR EYE NOTICES MISALIGNMENT BEFORE YOUR BRAIN CAN EXPLAIN IT.

05 DENSITY

SCREEN / ZERODHA KITE HOLDINGS



A / ORIGINAL

VS



B / BROKEN

A Dense, compact rows. Lots of data visible at once. Built for people who scan fast.

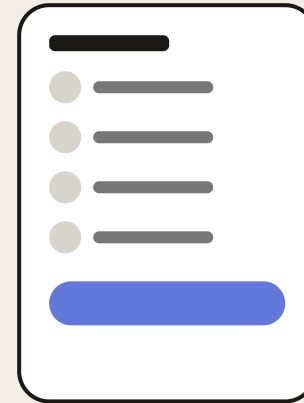
B Huge cards, massive whitespace, fewer rows, giant type. Prettier on a Dribbble shot, worse for the job.

"which one would an active trader want?"

GOOD UI IS CONTEXTUAL. DENSITY IS NOT INHERENTLY BAD.

06 COLOUR

SCREEN / PHONEPE / RAZORPAY PAYMENT



A / ORIGINAL

VS



B / BROKEN

A Mostly neutral. One action colour. The next step is obvious.

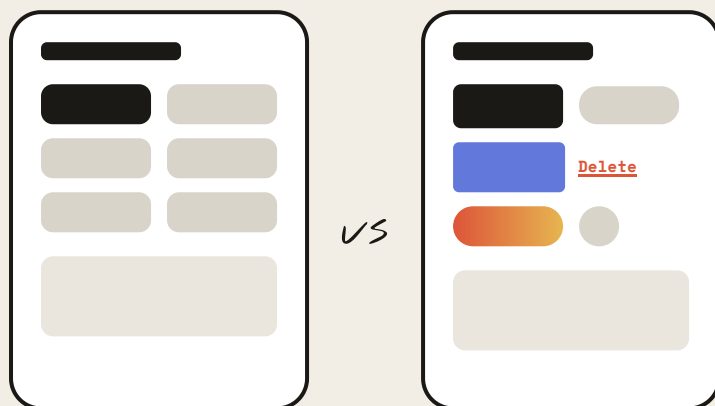
B Green success everywhere, purple brand everywhere, yellow offers, red warnings, blue links. Everything is shouting.

"how many things are asking for attention?"

COLOUR IS INFORMATION, NOT DECORATION.

07 COMPONENTS

SCREEN / ANY SAAS DASHBOARD



A / ORIGINAL

B / BROKEN

A One button system. Same heights, same radii, same icon sizes, one primary.

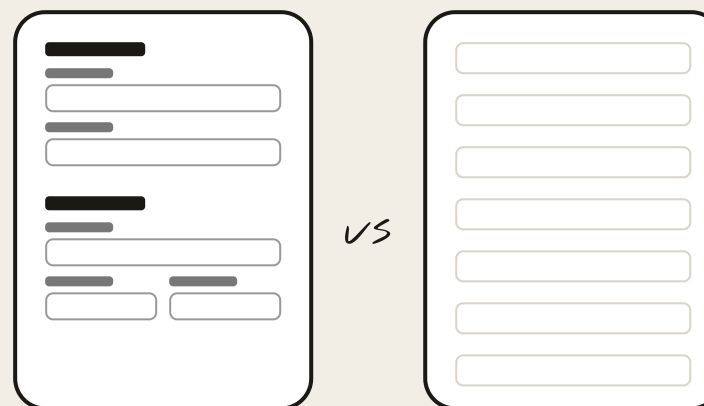
B Save 44px r8. Invite 40px r12. Export 48px r6. Delete as text. Create in gradient. Edit icon-only. Each one looks okay alone.

"why does the system look cheap?"

UI QUALITY DIES IN THE RELATIONSHIPS BETWEEN THINGS.

08 FORMS

SCREEN / CHECKOUT / SIGNUP



A / ORIGINAL

B / BROKEN

A Persistent labels. Fields grouped by meaning, with more space between groups than inside them.

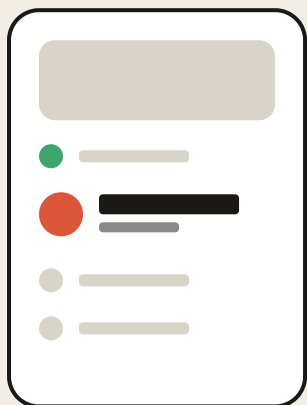
B Every field evenly spaced. No labels, no groups. You have to read everything to understand anything.

"which fields feel related?"

GROUPING IS SPACING DOING ITS JOB.

09 STATES

SCREEN / FOOD DELIVERY / ORDER TRACKING



A / ORIGINAL

A Done steps quiet, current step loud, future steps faded.



B / BROKEN

B Every step has equal emphasis. The screen lists the process but never says where you are.

"what is happening right now?"

THE CURRENT STATE SHOULD BE THE LOUDEST THING ON SCREEN.

THE TRAP COMPARISON

BETTER UI IS NOT PRETTIER UI.

A / PRETTY

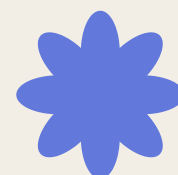
Minimal. Placeholder-only fields. No labels. Beautiful whitespace. Tiny secondary info.

B / BETTER

Persistent labels. Clear field grouping. Error guidance. Delivery estimate. Slightly denser.

"which is better?"

Visual designers usually pick A. B is the one that gets the checkout done. Always judge the screen against the task, not the Dribbble shot.





10 AI-GENERATED UI

SCREEN / FIGMA MAKE DASHBOARD

PROMPT 01

LAZY

"Create a dashboard for freelancers to track clients, invoices and monthly revenue."

Generate it. Don't critique yet. Run the Eye Test on it: hierarchy, spacing, type, alignment, density, colour, consistency.



PROMPT 02

DESIGNED

"Create a desktop dashboard for freelance designers managing 5 to 15 active clients. Monthly revenue and overdue invoices are the highest-priority information. Use moderate information density, clear hierarchy, restrained neutral colours with one accent, consistent 8px spacing logic and compact reusable components."

"what did AI technically get right but visually get wrong?"

FIGMA MAKE DIDN'T BECOME A BETTER DESIGNER. YOU GAVE IT BETTER DESIGN DECISIONS.

CRIME SCENE #04 / DO NOT CROSS

THE UI CRIME SCENE.

Build a folder of 15 real screenshots. Pull one up at random. You get **20 seconds** to diagnose it. No long explanations. Name the crime, then check your answer.

20

 SEC

you know it's working when you stop saying "looks clean" and start saying "grouping", "density", "optical alignment".

THE EYE TEST / RUN IT ON EVERY SCREEN



HIERARCHY

What is allowed to be loud?



SPACING

Does distance match relationship?



TYPE

How many sizes and weights? Why?



ALIGNMENT

Do edges actually line up?



DENSITY

Does it fit the user and the task?



COLOUR

Is colour carrying meaning?



CONSISTENCY

Do components behave like a system?